



Department of Economics
Johns Hopkins University
Baltimore, MD 21218
dedwar65@jh.edu

November 24, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics and Data Analytics
Campbell School of Business
Berry College
2277 Martha Berry Hwy NW
Mount Berry, GA 30149
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in the Department of Economics and Data Analytics at Berry College, beginning August 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Berry College's commitment to uniting rigorous academics with mentoring, experiential learning, and the development of students' "head, heart, and hands" strongly resonates with my teaching philosophy and approach to undergraduate education. I am especially drawn to the opportunity to teach upper-level courses such as economic development, risk and insurance, financial markets, or the history of economic thought, while contributing quantitative instruction that supports economics, business, and interdisciplinary programs.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students

“convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Berry, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, *Econometrics*, and related courses in development, financial markets, or economic thought, depending on departmental needs. I look forward to mentoring students, supporting internships and research experiences, and contributing to the college’s liberal-arts business mission.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) provide rigorous, data-driven instruction, (ii) integrate reproducible workflows and real-world applications into the classroom, and (iii) mentor students in research, professional development, and experiential learning settings. I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to Berry College’s mission of educating the whole student and cultivating thriving communities.

I would be honored to join the Department of Economics and Data Analytics at Berry College. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards